Why Parents Say No, and What to Do About It

Edurance · plain-words summary · October 2026

When we showed the Edurance idea to twenty imagined Hyderabad parents (twice, once with the first offer and once with the improved one), they said no twenty-five times in total, and the reasons were surprisingly consistent. **The biggest reason was screen time**: about half of the "no" answers said their child is already on the phone too much. **The second was tuition**: many families already pay a tuition teacher and trust a real person sitting next to their child more than an app. **The third was doubt that it really works or will last**: parents had seen children drop other learning apps within weeks, and a good score on Edurance's own test does not prove better school marks. **The fourth was data**: parents did not want their child's information going to an unknown AI company. **The fifth was "the school should pay, not me"**, because if the teacher assigns it, it feels like a hidden fee. Price on its own was the main reason for only one parent.

We suggest three changes. **The most important is to let the school pay** instead of the parents, for example ₹1,200 per student for the whole year, or included in the school fees. This removes the "school should pay" complaint, means parents no longer weigh it against their tutor, and puts the school's name behind the data promise; our rough numbers suggest it could turn the first year from a loss of about ₹58,000 into a profit of about ₹3 lakh, and it needs no new building, only a conversation and a contract. **The second change is to bring the tutor in and show real proof**: let parents share the gap report with their tuition teacher, show the child's real school test marks next to Edurance's re-test, and have a teacher check the AI explanations every week. This is medium effort and mainly wins over tuition-paying families. **The third is to make it light on screens**, with a daily time limit, printable practice sheets, or using the school's computer period. It is cheap and worth doing, but in our test it did not change any worried parent's mind on its own.

To test the most important idea cheaply, **meet ten school principals in one area over the next two weeks** and give each a simple choice on paper: either the school pays a small deposit, such as ₹5,000 for one class for one term, or the school gets a free pilot and parents are asked to pay ₹299 a month afterwards. Ask them to sign a one-page letter for the option they choose, and also ask what price per student per year would feel too expensive, who approves this kind of spending, and what parents pay for tuition. It costs only about ₹2,000 to ₹3,000 for printing. If two or more schools choose to pay, make "school pays" the main plan. If none pay but three or more want the free pilot, keep the parent plan and test it with real parents. If fewer than two agree to anything, rework how Edurance is pitched to schools before doing anything else.

Please keep one thing clear: **everything about parents' reasons in this page comes from AI-simulated parents, not real people**, and the profit and loss figures are estimates built on guessed costs. The only real facts so far are the details you gave us (₹299 a month, the school's 30% share, a budget under ₹2 lakh, unpaid founders, and a working app) and competitor prices found online. No real school or parent has been asked yet, which is exactly why the ten principal meetings matter: they will give you your first real evidence. (Simulated buyers tend to say yes more easily than real ones. Not financial or legal advice.)